



AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)

Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08

SARS Approved PBO: 930092287

Section 18A application pending

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www.africansolidaritycivic.org

CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Old Mutual × ASCO

Rural Youth Skills, Participation and Sustainable Livelihoods Pilot

Requested CSI investment: R100,000

Proposed implementation area: A South African rural or under-served community selected by ASCO after a documented needs assessment; the exact province/site is not established by the sources and is proposed for confirmation with Old Mutual.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Old Mutual** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Rural Youth Skills, Participation and Sustainable Livelihoods Pilot**. The proposed request is **R100,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is a South African Non-Profit Company and a SARS-approved Public Benefit Organisation, reference number **930092287**. ASCO's **Section 18A application is currently pending**; ASCO does not represent that it has Section 18A approval or that current donations are Section 18A tax deductible.

The proposal in one sentence: Rural Youth Skills, Participation and Sustainable Livelihoods Pilot in A South African rural or under-served community selected by ASCO after a documented needs assessment; the exact province/site is not established by the sources and is proposed for confirmation with Old Mutual., benefiting Proposed: 30 unemployed or under-employed South African youth, primarily ages 18-35, with deliberate inclusion of young women and other structurally excluded participants; final numbers and eligibility should follow the selected community assessment and funder requirements. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Old Mutual's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting

R100,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable

Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu

Executive Director

African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)

PBO Reference: 930092287

Tel: +27 76 757 5773

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The proposed project

Project title Rural Youth Skills, Participation and Sustainable Livelihoods Pilot	Implementation period Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.
Location A South African rural or under-served community selected by ASCO after a documented needs assessment; the exact province/site is not established by the sources and is proposed for confirmation with Old Mutual.	Target beneficiaries Proposed: 30 unemployed or under-employed South African youth, primarily ages 18-35, with deliberate inclusion of young women and other structurally excluded participants; final numbers and eligibility should follow the selected community assessment and funder requirements.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed: recruit and enrol 30 youth in a 6-month community development and livelihood-skills pilot.
- Proposed: deliver at least 6 practical training and financial-literacy sessions, with attendance and pre/post learning records.
- Proposed: facilitate at least 3 youth-led community improvement activities designed and implemented with participant input.
- Proposed: develop 10 basic livelihood or micro-enterprise action plans and provide structured mentoring/referral support; these are targets, not completed results.
- Proposed: produce a baseline, safeguarding record, beneficiary disaggregation, expenditure report, outcome dashboard and final narrative report.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need** → **practical intervention** → **measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

Evidence discipline: All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Old Mutual?

ASCO's proposed community development, youth participation and sustainable-livelihoods project could cautiously align with Old Mutual's documented interests in education and skills, youth employability, entrepreneurship, economic inclusion, rural/community development and sustainable socio-economic outcomes. A credible proposal should frame the R100,000 request as a non-commercial public-benefit pilot with measurable youth skills, participation and livelihood outputs, partnership/governance arrangements, safeguarding, and monitoring and evaluation. This is an alignment hypothesis only; no Old Mutual commitment, partnership or approval is established.

Verified company context

- The Old Mutual Foundation is Old Mutual's social-investment arm and states that it pursues inclusive, transformative and sustainable socio-economic development through partnerships with government, civil society and the private sector.
- The Foundation's stated mandate is transformation in South Africa and across the continent, including integrating structurally excluded South Africans into the mainstream economy, addressing youth unemployment, alleviating poverty and inequality, and supporting vulnerable communities.
- The Foundation page identifies two current focus areas: Education and Humanitarian Disaster Support.
- The Foundation's 2021-2025 strategic direction included education plus humanitarian and disaster support; its education strategy included literacy, numeracy and financial education.
- The 2021 Foundation report describes post-school education and training support for unemployed youth, including employment access, improved livelihoods, digital literacy, green-economy skills and youth micro-businesses. It identifies a primary age focus of 18-25, with a wider catchment of 15-35.
- The Foundation report says it prioritises rural communities and uses partnership, evidence-based intervention, monitoring/evaluation/reporting and blended or co-funding approaches.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R60,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R8,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R6,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R8,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R7,000	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R7,000	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R4,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	R100,000	Equals the proposed request.

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding

Company funds the proposed project at R100,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding

Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership

Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support

Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Old Mutual Foundation annual report lists omefp@oldmutual.com for further information. For the separate Old Mutual Insure CSI route, the official page lists csirequests@ominsure.co.za for requests benefiting children, youth, women, people with disabilities and older people. No current public Foundation application form or open call was verified; contact the Foundation first and ask for current eligibility, proposal format, deadlines and required compliance documents.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- The Foundation page does not publish a detailed open-grant eligibility policy, current call for proposals, funding ceiling, deadlines or guaranteed application process; confirm these directly before submission.
- The Foundation report is for 2021 and describes a 2021-2025 strategy; do not assume every historical programme or priority remains open in the current cycle.
- Old Mutual Foundation focus areas are stated as Education and Humanitarian Disaster Support, so a livelihoods proposal should explicitly connect livelihoods to education/skills and economic inclusion rather than present an unsupported standalone enterprise grant.
- The public sources do not confirm whether an organisation with ASCO's pending Section 18A application is eligible. ASCO may state its South African NPC status and SARS-approved PBO reference 930092287, but must not claim Section 18A approval.
- No source confirms that Old Mutual will fund ASCO, a specific province/community, or the proposed R100,000 amount. The location and targets below are proposed, not verified commitments.
- The Old Mutual Insure CSI email is a separate insurer route and should not be represented as the Old Mutual Foundation's route without confirmation.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Old Mutual** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu

Executive Director

African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)

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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. <https://www.oldmutual.co.za/about/old-mutual-foundation/>
2. <https://www.oldmutual.co.za/about/sustainability/>
3. https://www.oldmutual.com/om-docs/bltfd824d2b0e6d2fec/Old_Mutual_Foundation_2021_Annual_Report.pdf
4. https://www.oldmutual.com/om-docs/blt5760c3a0e360d95a/Sustainability_Report_2024.pdf
5. <https://www.oldmutual.co.za/about/old-mutual-insure/responsible-business-and-corporate-social-investments/>

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.